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On the November evening in 1966 when I learned I had been elected governor of California, three of our four children—Maureen, Mike, and Ron—joined Nancy and me at a victory celebration. Patti was away at school in Arizona and when we called and told her that I'd won, she started to cry. She was only fourteen, but as a child of the sixties she believed the antiestablishment rhetoric that was popular among members of her generation, and she let me know that she didn't like having a member of the establishment in the family.

In different ways, the election changed the lives of everyone in our family that night.

As funny as it might seem now, when I gave in to the appeals to run for governor, I had never given much thought to the possibility I might win. All the emphasis had been on deciding whether to run and bringing the party back together. I'd figured, "Well, okay, I'll run and help the party with the unity problem, then in November it will all be over."

Well, it wasn't over. I had less than two months to prepare for putting my ideas about government into practice. Nancy started packing for Sacramento and we put the ranch up for sale.

Although I may have been (as the papers put it) a "citizen politician" whom reporters liked to compare to the Jimmy Stewart character in *Mr. Smith Goes to Washington*, I knew that reality often turned out to be a lot more complicated than Hollywood portrayed it, and I knew I had to do some quick homework about my new job before arriving in Sacramento. After years of criticizing government, I was